Amazon Seller Account Setup Guide: US, UAE and Saudi Arabia

Covers three stores: **Amazon.com (US)**, **Amazon.ae (UAE)** and **Amazon.sa (Saudi Arabia / KSA)**.

- **Part A** below is the general process, written for the US store. Most of it (product choice, FBA, listings, Brand Registry) works the same in all three.
- **Part B** covers what is different in the UAE and Saudi Arabia: licences, documents, fees, customs and VAT.
- **Part C** recommends which store to open first.

> Each store needs its **own legal documents, tax registration and FBA stock in that country**. You can manage them from one Seller Central login once the accounts are linked, but you cannot ship US stock to UAE or Saudi customers through FBA.

Part A — General setup (written for Amazon.com)

Legend: 👤 **only you can do this** (needs your identity, bank, tax or legal signature) · 🤝 **I can help you prepare it**

Phase 0 — Before you sign up (1–3 days)

#	Step	Who
0.1	Decide your business model. **Recommended for a beginner: Private Label or Wholesale using FBA (Fulfillment by Amazon).** Avoid dropshipping from other retailers (Amazon bans it).	🤝
0.2	Decide **Individual** (0.99*peritemsold*)*vs* * *Professional* * (39.99/month) plan. Choose Professional once you expect >40 sales/month; it unlocks ads, coupons, deals, Brand Registry tools and bulk listing.	🤝
0.3	Register a business (optional but recommended): an LLC in the US, or a sole proprietorship / company in your country. Non-US sellers can sell on amazon.com without a US company.	👤
0.4	Get a dedicated business email and phone number you will keep long term.	👤
0.5	Set aside starting capital. A realistic first private-label order is **2,000–5,000** (inventory + samples + photos + first month of ads).	👤

Phase 1 — Gather your documents

Have these ready **before** you start; mismatched details are the #1 reason accounts get stuck in verification.

- 👤 Government photo ID (passport or national ID / driver's license), not expired, name exactly as on your bank account
- 👤 Recent bank or credit-card statement, or utility bill (last 180 days) showing the **same name and address**
- 👤 Chargeable international credit card (Visa / Mastercard) for the monthly fee
- 👤 Bank account that can receive USD payouts (a US account, or a service such as Payoneer / Wise / Amazon Currency Converter for Sellers)
- 👤 Tax ID: US SSN or EIN for US persons; non-US sellers complete the **W-8BEN** (individual) or **W-8BEN-E** (business) interview
- 👤 Business registration documents (if registering as a company)

Phase 2 — Create the Seller Central account (about 1 hour + 1–3 weeks verification)

1. 👤 Go to **sell.amazon.com** → *Sign up*. Use the business email from step 0.4 (not your personal shopping account if you can avoid it).
2. 👤 Enter business type, legal name and address exactly as on your documents.
3. 👤 Enter your ID and personal details.
4. 👤 Add the credit card and deposit (bank) account.
5. 👤 Complete the **tax interview** (W-9 or W-8BEN / W-8BEN-E).
6. 👤 Enter store name (you can change it later) and answer product questions (UPC/GTIN, brand ownership).
7. 👤 **Identity verification**: upload documents and complete the **video call** or in-person verification with Amazon. Have the original documents in hand.
8. 👤 Verify your address via the postcard / code Amazon sends (if requested).

> ⚠️ Open **only one** seller account per person/business. Duplicate accounts get suspended.

Phase 3 — Set up your shop properly (week 1–2 after approval)

#	Step	Who
3.1	Turn on **two-step verification** and add a backup phone.	👤
3.2	Fill out *Settings → Account Info*: return address, shipping settings, business hours, notifications.	👤
3.3	Enrol in **FBA** (*Settings → Fulfillment by Amazon*).	👤
3.4	Choose your first product using the daily report (see `daily-reports/`). Run the numbers in Amazon's **Revenue Calculator** before ordering.	🤝
3.5	File a **trademark** for your brand name (USPTO, ~$350 per class). Use **Amazon IP Accelerator** to get Brand Registry while the trademark is pending.	👤 (I can draft the brand name shortlist)
3.6	Enrol in **Amazon Brand Registry** once the trademark is filed. This unlocks A+ Content, Brand Store, Sponsored Brands, Vine and Brand Analytics.	👤
3.7	Buy **GS1 UPC barcodes** (gs1us.org) or apply for a GTIN exemption if your brand is registered.	👤

#	Step	Who
3.8	Source the product: request samples from 3–5 suppliers (Alibaba, Global Sources, or local manufacturers). Check quality yourself before a bulk order. Use a third-party inspection for orders over ~$3,000.	👤 (I can write supplier messages and compare quotes)
3.9	Create the listing: title, 5 bullet points, description, backend keywords, 7+ images (white-background main image, lifestyle images, infographic) and a video.	🤝 I can write the copy and keyword list
3.10	Create an FBA shipment in Seller Central and send inventory to the warehouse Amazon assigns. Label every carton.	👤
3.11	Once inventory is live, start the launch plan in `02-promotion-plan.md`.	🤝

Typical timeline

Week	Milestone
1	Documents ready, account application submitted
2–3	Verification done, trademark filed, product chosen, samples ordered
4–8	Samples approved, bulk order produced, listing and photos prepared
8–10	Inventory arrives at FBA, listing goes live, launch ads start

Key costs to budget (US, 2026)

- Professional plan: **$39.99/month**
- Referral fee: **~15%** of sale price in most categories (8% in some categories for low-priced items; check Amazon's fee schedule for your category)
- FBA fulfilment fee: roughly **3.50–6.50 per unit** for a small, light standard-size item; more for larger items. Peak-season surcharge applies 15 Oct – 14 Jan.
- Monthly storage fee, plus an inbound placement fee depending on how you ship
- Advertising: plan **15–30/day** during launch
- Rule of thumb: **landed product cost should be ≤ 25% of your selling price** to leave a healthy margin after Amazon fees and ads.

Rules that will get you suspended (avoid these)

- Paying for reviews, giving free products in exchange for reviews, or asking only happy customers to review
- Reviews from friends and family
- Inserts asking for a 5-star review
- Selling restricted / gated products without approval (supplements, toys in Q4, topicals, etc. may need extra approval or testing)
- Using another brand's trademark in your listing
- Multiple seller accounts

Part B — UAE (Amazon.ae) and Saudi Arabia (Amazon.sa)

B1. Side-by-side comparison

	🇺🇸 Amazon.com	🇦🇪 Amazon.ae	🇸🇦 Amazon.sa
Who can open an account	Anyone with a passport, international credit card and bank account. No US company needed	**UAE trade licence required** (Amazon now requires a commercial licence for every UAE seller)	**Saudi Commercial Registration (CR) required.** Foreigners usually need a **MISA investment licence** first
Cheapest legal setup	Sole trader in your home country, or a US LLC	Free-zone e-commerce licence (from ~AED 5,750/yr) or Dubai E-Trader licence (AED 1,370, Dubai residents only, limited)	Saudi/GCC citizen: sole establishment CR (~SAR 1,200–2,000) + Chamber of Commerce (~SAR 2,000–3,000/yr)
Monthly plan	$39.99	~AED 184 (Amazon currently shows **no monthly fee for a limited time**)	~SAR 137 after a free trial period
Referral fees	~15% most categories	5–15% by category. Pet, beauty, health, baby: **8% up to AED 50**, 15% above	Category-based, similar to UAE. Check the Amazon.sa fee page for your category
FBA fee (small standard item)	~$3.50–6.50	~AED 7–20	Size/weight based, check Revenue Calculator
Sales tax / VAT	Amazon collects state sales tax for you	**5% VAT**. Must register above AED 375,000/yr sales (voluntary from AED 187,500). You account for VAT, not Amazon	**15% VAT**. Must register above SAR 375,000/yr (voluntary from SAR 187,500). Fatoora e-invoicing applies
Import duty	Varies by product (HTS code)	5% customs duty + 5% import VAT on CIF value	Usually 5–15% duty + 15% import VAT
You are importer of record?	Yes (or your freight forwarder)	**Yes, you need your own Dubai Customs importer code**	Yes, via your CR
Product certificates	Category-specific (e.g. UL for electrics, CPC for kids)	Conformity certificates for regulated categories (ECAS / MoIAT)	**SABER / SASO** certificate for most regulated goods; SFDA for cosmetics, food, supplements, medical
Language	English	English + Arabic recommended	**Arabic strongly recommended**; Arabic labelling where required
Payout bank	Any (Payoneer / Wise work)	**UAE corporate bank account (IBAN)**	**Saudi corporate bank account (IBAN)**
Corporate tax	Depends on your home country / US entity	9% above AED 375,000 profit (Small Business Relief available under AED 3m revenue to 2029)	Zakat (Saudi/GCC owned) or 20% income tax (foreign owned)

> Figures are indicative (2026 snapshots from licence providers and Amazon pages). Confirm

> on Seller Central and with a local accountant before committing.

B2. UAE (Amazon.ae) step by step

#	Step	Who
U1	Choose a licence: **free-zone e-commerce licence** is the usual choice (cheaper, 100% foreign ownership). Mainland DET licence (~AED 15,000+) if you also want to sell to shops.	👤 (I can compare free zones for you)
U2	Get the licence, Memorandum of Association, and establishment card.	👤
U3	Open a **UAE corporate bank account** and get the IBAN letter.	👤
U4	Register for a **Dubai Customs importer code** (via Dubai Trade) so you can clear FBA stock.	👤
U5	Register for **VAT (TRN)** once you approach AED 375,000 sales (or voluntarily from day 1 to reclaim import VAT).	👤
U6	Sign up at **sell.amazon.ae** with: trade licence, MoA, Emirates ID + passport of the signatory, IBAN letter, credit card, VAT certificate (if registered). Complete identity verification.	👤
U7	File a **UAE trademark** (Ministry of Economy) to enrol in Brand Registry for Amazon.ae.	👤
U8	Create listings in **English and Arabic** (I can write both). Ship stock to the Amazon.ae fulfilment centre with commercial invoice, packing list, certificate of origin and HS codes.	🤝

B3. Saudi Arabia (Amazon.sa) step by step

#	Step	Who
S1	**If you are a Saudi or GCC citizen:** register a sole establishment or company on the Saudi Business Center and get a **CR**. **If you are an expat or foreign investor:** get a **MISA investment licence** first, then incorporate and get a CR (expect 1–3 months and a business-setup consultant).	👤
S2	Join the **Chamber of Commerce**; open a **Saudi corporate bank account**.	👤
S3	Register with **ZATCA** for VAT once near SAR 375,000 sales (voluntarily earlier to reclaim import VAT); set up Fatoora e-invoicing when your wave applies.	👤
S4	Check your product on **SABER**: get the Product Certificate of Conformity and Shipment Certificate before shipping. Cosmetics, supplements and food also need **SFDA** registration. Choose products that need **little or no certification** for your first launch.	👤 (I can check which certificates a product needs)
S5	Sign up at **sell.amazon.sa** with: CR, ID/Iqama/passport of the owner, Saudi IBAN, VAT certificate (if registered), credit card. Complete identity verification.	👤
S6	File a **Saudi trademark** (SAIP) for Brand Registry on Amazon.sa.	👤
S7	Create listings in **Arabic and English** with Arabic keywords; ship stock to FBA centres near Riyadh, Jeddah or Dammam.	🤝

Part C — Which store to open first

Opening all three at once triples the paperwork, stock and ad budgets. Recommended order:

1. **Start in the country where you already live and can get licences fastest.**
    - Living in the **UAE**: start with **Amazon.ae** (free-zone licence) **and/or Amazon.com** (no local company needed).
    - **Saudi/GCC citizen in KSA**: start with **Amazon.sa** (CR is quick for citizens; competition is thinner and ad clicks cheaper than the UAE).
    - Living elsewhere: start with **Amazon.com** (no local company needed, biggest market).
2. **Launch one product in one store**, get it to steady sales and 20+ reviews (6–12 weeks).
3. **Expand the same product to the next store**, re-using photos, listing copy and supplier. Only the paperwork, Arabic listing and certificates are new.

Timing: Ramadan 2027 is expected to start around **8 February 2027**, with Eid al-Fitr around **9–10 March 2027**. This is the biggest shopping season in the UAE and KSA. If you want to catch it, your stock needs to be at Amazon.ae / Amazon.sa by **late January 2027**, so licence and supplier decisions need to be made in the next 2–3 weeks.